

Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠4

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦J

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣5

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥3

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠3

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 2♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥3

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 6 5
♥ 8 5 2
♦ J 8 7 6 5
♣ A 3

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 10 4
♦ K 9
♣ Q J 10 8 5



♠ 8 4 3
♥ K J 6
♦ 10 3 2
♣ K 7 4 2

♠ A 10 9 2
♥ Q 9 7 3
♦ A Q 4
♣ 9 6

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠4			

SOUTH's 2♣ bid is Stayman, asking for a 4-card Major.

NORTH's 2♦ bid denies four cards in either Major.

SOUTH knows there is no 8-card Major fit. He also knows the partnership has at least 26 points so he bids 3NT.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 8 7 5 4

♥ 8 6

♦ K Q 3

♣ 7 2

♠ 9 2

♥ J 10 5 4

♦ 8 7 4

♣ K 9 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10

♥ K Q 9 3

♦ A 5 2

♣ A 10 8 6

♠ A 6 3

♥ A 7 2

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ Q J 3

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♦ J

WEST, with 11 points and six ♠s, knows immediately that the final contract will be 4♠ since the partners must have at least eight ♠s and at least 26 points.

She concludes that it might be better for EAST to be the Declarer so she bids 2♥ as a Jacoby Transfer. When EAST makes the required 2♠ bid she just bids 4♠ which closes the auction with EAST as Declarer.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 2
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ Q 10 9 4
 ♣ 9 8 5 2

♠ 6 4 3

♥ A K J 7 6 5

♦ 8 2

♣ Q 7



♠ Q J 10 9
 ♥ 10 4
 ♦ A J 6 3
 ♣ 10 6 4

♠ K 7 5

♥ Q 9 3

♦ K 7 5

♣ A K J 3

NORTH knows the partnership has a fit in ♥s since SOUTH must have at least a doubleton. He also knows the partnership holds at least 27 points.

He prefers SOUTH be the Declarer, (to protect against the opening lead), so he uses a Jacoby Transfer.

The contract might go down if played by NORTH, but is odds on when played by SOUTH.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♣5			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 6 5
♥ A 10 4
♦ Q J 9 7
♣ K 8

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ 9 3 2

♦ A 6

♣ A Q 6 2



♠ 7 3

♥ K Q 8 6

♦ K 4 2

♣ J 10 9 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ J 7 5

♦ 10 8 5 3

♣ 7 4 3

EAST, with 9 points and a 4-card ♥ suit is just strong enough to use Stayman.

WEST shows 4 ♠s and EAST describes her minimum hand with no ♠ fit by bidding 2NT.

WEST has a maximum 1NT opening and bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♥3			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 7
♥ K 5 4
♦ A 10 8 4
♣ K 10 5

♠ K J 4

♥ Q 10

♦ K Q J 6

♣ A 9 7 3



♠ Q 6 5 3 2

♥ 7 6 2

♦ 9 3

♣ Q 4 2

♠ A 9

♥ A J 9 8 3

♦ 7 5 2

♣ J 8 6

SOUTH has 11 points and five ♥s, so she responds
2♦ as a Jacoby Transfer.

When NORTH bids the required 2♥, SOUTH jumps
to 3NT to show at least 11 points, but only a 5-card
♥ suit.

Since NORTH has only a doubleton ♥ she passes
3NT.

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠3			

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8 5

♦ 9 5 4

♣ 5 3

♠ A 10

♥ K Q 10 9

♦ J 10 6 2

♣ 10 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 5

♥ A 7 6

♦ A 8 3

♣ K Q 9 4

♠ 9 4

♥ J 4 3 2

♦ K Q 7

♣ A J 8 7

EAST, with a balanced 17 point hand naturally opens 1NT.

WEST has a really awful hand, but she does hold six ♠s. So she uses Jacoby Transfer, and when EAST bids 2♠ she passes!

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

2♠

1NT

Pass

All Pass

2♠ by East

Lead: ♥3